Developing a Library Archive for Secure Data Storage

Stewardship Options for Sensitive Data

Introduction

- Awareness of RDM Requirements at Canadian Schools
- Faculty IT staff reached out to RDM services in Library
- Who is responsible for curation of data?

The Need

- Specific case of large multinational multi-year project
  - Data left on faculty server
  - Seeking long-term storage location
- Proposal for $money/space
- Request made from RDM in library for support to house a drive for data
- Tri-Agency RDM policy and anticipation of data deposit mandate

Requirements - Technical & Procedural

- Secure library data deposit
  - Network drive
- Considerations (security, permissions, transferring data from / how)
  - Several IT groups
  - Future / ongoing usage
- Access protocols and stewardship

Use cases

- Data that needs to be deposited to meet a requirement from a funding agency, but should not be shared outside original team
- Data that cannot be shared openly, but can be shared beyond the original research team under specific conditions
- Data where the researcher wants a local preservation copy on a secure service

The Form

- The data deposit form ended up being our primary procedural document and was developed over approximately a year and a half of negotiation
- Review and sign-off from:
  - Ethics officers from our research office
  - Members of Research Data Infrastructure Working Group (cross-university group that developed our RDM strategy)
  - Entire Research Ethics Board
- Primary concerns:
  - Deposit and future use must be in line with ethics approval and consent form.
  - Should meet current and anticipated Tri-Agency requirements.
  - Need to deal with stewardship in absence of original depositor.

Terms for sharing and reuse

Indicate how and under what condition this data can be shared with researchers outside the original research team. Your most recently approved REB application form and consent form(s), if applicable, must allow this reuse. Please include this documentation.

- ❑ Data is being deposited for archival purposes only. Only the original research team may access the data. Please identify persons and provide contact information:
- ❑ Data can be shared with the explicit permission of the following person or persons (e.g. depositor, members of original research team, data review committee, etc.) The applicable REB will review these conditions.l.
- ❑ Data can be shared by request if certain conditions are met (e.g. approval by research ethics board, completion of a secure data management plan explaining how data will be kept secure during reuse project, signing of conditions document, or any other conditions). Please detai (attach additional documents as needed). The applicable REB will review these conditions.
- ❑ Data can be shared openly. It is being deposited in the secure archive for long term preservation.

Data review

- Originally envisioned straightforward data collections containing *data*
- First deposit contained
  - personnel records for research assistants
  - grant book-keeping
  - various other items vaguely related to the project including **somebody's entire Outlook email archive**.
- How do we define "data"? We don't want to be a repository for any random file someone doesn't want to discard.
- Will funders with deposit requirements help answer these questions?
- REB does not necessarily have the expertise or interest to make long term decisions on data access - a Data Access Committee would be useful

This sloth is here to commemorate the communications process and timeline.

Questions, comments, feedback?

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